

WHO AM I?

Annie Turnbo Malone

flip for key events and role

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**Madam C.J. Walker
(Sarah Breedlove)**

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Langston Hughes

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W.E.B. Du Bois

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Booker T. Washington

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Woodrow Wilson

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First Black female self-made millionaire

Worked as Malone's Poro Agent ~1 year; launched own hair care line ~1905; built 40,000-agent national salesforce; became one of America's first self-made female millionaires; died 1919.

Poro Company founder

Founded Poro hair care company in St. Louis (late 1890s); copyrighted brand 1902; trained thousands of Black women agents; became millionaire philanthropist; Sarah Breedlove worked as her Poro Agent before launching her own line.

Civil rights intellectual and NAACP co-founder

Demanded immediate full civil/political rights vs. Washington's accommodation; co-founded NAACP (1909); founded CRISIS magazine; endorsed Wilson (1912) then condemned him publicly in CRISIS (1913) for re-segregating federal government.

Voice of the Harlem Renaissance

Prolific poet/playwright (1920s–1967); embedded jazz and blues into poetry; celebrated Black life and demanded dignity; 'Mother to Son' among most famous works; defining literary voice of the Harlem Renaissance.

28th President / federal segregationist

28th U.S. President (1913–1921); won 1912 election with Black support; immediately re-segregated Post Office, Treasury, and federal workspaces; required photos on job applications to enable racial screening; Wilson believed segregation reduced racial 'friction.'

Atlanta Compromise / vocational uplift

Delivered Atlanta Compromise speech (1895) advocating vocational training and political accommodation over immediate civil rights; founded Tuskegee Institute; ideology contrasted sharply with Du Bois's demand for immediate equality.

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Marcus Garvey

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Victor Hugo Green

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Rosa Parks

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Dr. Martin Luther King Jr.

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Thurgood Marshall

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James Meredith

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The Green Book

Published the annual Negro Motorist Green Book (1936–1966) — essential travel guide listing safe businesses and lodging for Black travelers navigating a violently segregated America.

UNIA / Black Nationalism / Back to Africa

Founded UNIA in Jamaica (1914); expanded to Harlem 1916; launched Black Star Steamship Line; published Negro World newspaper; built largest Black mass movement in history promoting Pan-African nationalism; deported 1927.

Civil Rights Movement leader / SCLC president

Led Montgomery Boycott (1955–56); co-founded SCLC (1957); 'I Have a Dream' speech at March on Washington (Aug. 28, 1963); Nobel Peace Prize (1964); predicted Black president in 1967; assassinated April 4, 1968 in Memphis while supporting striking sanitation workers.

Montgomery Bus Boycott catalyst

NAACP secretary trained at Highlander Folk School; arrested Dec. 1, 1955 for refusing to give up her bus seat in Montgomery, AL; her arrest triggered the 381-day Montgomery Bus Boycott, ending bus segregation and launching Dr. King nationally.

Integration of University of Mississippi

First Black student admitted to Ole Miss; enrolled Sept. 30, 1962 requiring 31,000 federal troops after deadly riots; his enrollment was a defining showdown of massive resistance vs. federal authority.

NAACP Legal Defense Fund / Brown v. Board

Chief attorney arguing Brown v. Board of Education (1954) before the Supreme Court; won unanimous ruling overturning Plessy v. Ferguson; later became the first Black Supreme Court Justice (1967).

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Bull Connor
(Theophilus Eugene Connor)

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John Lewis

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Fannie Lou Hamer

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Medgar Evers

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Myrlie Evers-Williams

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Huey P. Newton

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SNCC chairman / Freedom Rider / March on Washington

SNCC chairman; Freedom Rider beaten in Anniston and Montgomery (1961); youngest speaker at March on Washington (1963); led marchers beaten on Bloody Sunday at Edmund Pettus Bridge, Selma (March 7, 1965); later U.S. Representative from Georgia.

Commissioner of Public Safety, Birmingham

Birmingham Public Safety Commissioner who ordered fire hoses and police dogs used against Children's Crusade marchers (May 1963); his brutality was broadcast worldwide and directly accelerated congressional action on the Civil Rights Act.

NAACP Mississippi field secretary / martyred leader

WWII veteran; NAACP's first Mississippi field secretary; organized voter registration and boycotts; shot in his Jackson, MS driveway on June 12, 1963 — the night JFK addressed the nation on civil rights. Killer convicted only in 1994.

Mississippi voting rights / SNCC leader

Sharecropper who registered to vote (1962); evicted the same day; jailed and beaten in Winona, MS (1963); electrified the nation testifying at the 1964 DNC — 'I'm sick and tired of being sick and tired'; co-founded Mississippi Freedom Democratic Party.

Black Panther Party co-founder

Co-founded the Black Panther Party with Bobby Seale in Oakland (1966); developed Ten Point Program; championed armed self-defense against police brutality; party also operated free breakfast programs, health clinics, and liberation schools.

Civil rights activist / NAACP national chair

Wife of Medgar Evers; continued his civil rights work after his 1963 assassination; pursued his killer for 31 years; served as NAACP national board chair (1995–1998); delivered invocation at Obama's second inauguration (2013).

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Bobby Seale

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Reginald Lewis

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Cathy Hughes

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Curtis Robinson

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Barack Obama

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Mary McLeod Bethune

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Wall Street pioneer / TLC Beatrice

Grew up in Baltimore; decided to pursue law at age 7; Harvard Law School; opened first Black law firm on Wall Street (1970); executed record \$985M leveraged buyout of Beatrice International (1987); wealthiest Black man in America; died Jan. 19, 1993.

Black Panther Party co-founder

Co-founded Black Panther Party with Huey P. Newton in Oakland (1966); organized community programs including the Free Breakfast for School Children program, which fed 20,000 children daily at its peak.

Four Laws of Economic Empowerment

Moved from Jim Crow Alabama to Connecticut; guided by four laws from his mother: Law of Self-Sufficiency, Law of First, Law of Sacrifice (delay gratification), and Law of Giving — a framework for economic survival and generational advancement.

Urban One / Radio One founder

Founded Radio One (1980) in Washington, D.C.; grew into Urban One — largest Black-owned media company in the U.S.; first Black woman to chair a publicly traded company (1999); empowers Black communities with culturally relevant media.

Educator / presidential advisor / NCNW founder

Founded Daytona Literary and Industrial Training School (1904) — now Bethune-Cookman University; co-founded National Council of Negro Women (1935); served as FDR's Director of Negro Affairs (1936–1944); the most politically powerful Black woman of her era. Famous 'I Leave You' legacy statement.

44th President of the United States

First African American U.S. President; elected Nov. 4, 2008; inaugurated Jan. 20, 2009; served two terms through Jan. 20, 2017; won Nobel Peace Prize (2009); Gallup's most admired man in America for 12 consecutive years. MLK Jr. had predicted a Black president in 1967.

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President Harry S. Truman

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Homer Plessy

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Chief Justice Earl Warren

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John Howard Griffin

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A. Philip Randolph

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Plessy v. Ferguson plaintiff

Louisiana Creole man who deliberately boarded a white-only railroad car (1892) to challenge Louisiana's Separate Car Act; lost in the Supreme Court (1896), which enshrined 'separate but equal' — legalizing Jim Crow for 58 years.

Executive Order 9981 — Military Desegregation

Signed Executive Order 9981 on July 26, 1948, desegregating the U.S. armed forces — the largest institutional desegregation in American history at that point, responding to Black WWII veterans' demands and Cold War civil rights pressure.

Black Like Me

White journalist who darkened his skin and traveled the Deep South in 1959 as a Black man; documented the experience in *Black Like Me* (1961) — a book that shocked white readers into confronting the lived reality of racial oppression.

Brown v. Board of Education — unanimous opinion

Chief Justice who wrote the unanimous Supreme Court opinion in *Brown v. Board* (May 17, 1954) declaring school segregation unconstitutional — the most consequential Supreme Court decision of the 20th century.

Labor organizer / March on Washington co-organizer

Organized Brotherhood of Sleeping Car Porters (1925) — first predominantly Black labor union to win a major contract; threatened mass march on Washington (1941) that pressured FDR to desegregate defense industries; co-organized 1963 March on Washington.